Curated Media: Broadcast News Editors' Views of Political Media Briefings on 2027 Election Coverage in Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria

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Abstract

Political media briefings are a common feature during election periods, bringing together journalists, who are expected to listen to political candidates, who in turn, take questions. It appears, however, that political media briefings are simply curated, with organisers controlling and gatekeeping the flow of information. This reality raises concerns about whether election reporting is increasingly being dependent on curated political communication. At the centre of this are broadcast news editors, whose duty includes probing proceeds of briefings. This study aimed to ascertain the views of broadcast editors in Akwa Ibom State on political media briefings regarding the 2027 general elections, paying particular attention to their perception; editorial disposition towards political briefings; the challenges and opportunities political briefings present for electoral journalism; and how they balance access to political sources with editorial independence. With the gatekeeping theory as a framework, the study adopted a qualitative approach, drawing respondents scheduled for interview from select broadcast outfits, including NTA Uyo, ADBN TV, and for radio, XL FM and Inspiration FM. A thematic analysis was employed for data analysis, with findings organised thematically, too. The findings showed that political press briefings were considered an important source of political information given during elections, but also lays a burden on news editors, who rely on diverse pillars to determine what is eventually broadcast. Hence, the study concluded that political press briefings, especially ahead of the 2027 general elections in Nigeria, presents a two-edged situation, but remains important for electoral journalism. It recommended that broadcasting organisations should strengthen newsroom protocols for handling political briefings, particularly through systematic verification, clear separation of paid political communication from editorial content, balanced sourcing and documentation of attempts to obtain competing perspectives.

Keywords: Curated media, Political media briefings, Election coverage, News editors, Broadcast journalism

Introduction

Journalism - print or broadcast, in its purest form, takes the responsibility of informing society of events around it. In addition to information, other functions include education, entertainment, correlation, etc. Through these functions, Shi (2023) notes that journalism, within the context of public affairs, holds power to account. Yet, none of these functions is performed based simply on a journalist's imagination; they are characterised by reliance on sources, some of which could be human, while others are documents, all of which lend credence and trustworthiness to news reports and several other media contents.

Moreover, among the news sources are press statements and media briefings. According to De Semir, Ribas and Revuelta (1998), press statements serve as publicity materials for science journals, extending findings from scientific studies. Such is the case with political and electoral press statements; politicians and electoral bodies, such as Nigeria's Independent National Electoral Commission, make their activities public through press statements. The expectation, usually, is that journalists will write and publish news reports based on the content of the statements, and while at it, Mellado, et. al., (2020) observe that they express professional ideals into which they are socialised.

While Mellado, et al., (2020) further report gaps in the role conception and actual performance among journalists, Nwodu, Ekwunife and Ikegbunam (2025) opine that the image of journalism practice is

long-damaged over gratifications. However, an even deeper question exists regarding how journalists - broadcast news editors in the case of this study - treat content of media briefings, which have been conceptualised as curated media. The concept, apart from underscoring the disablement of exclusivity to information (Nwankpa, Umoren & Utuk, 2021), highlights the reality of arranging journalists and supplying them with pre-arranged information that they are expected to publish, sometimes, with little or no questioning. This development makes the process more or less curated, given that organisers of media briefings direct the flow of events, and sometimes, tactically avoid probing questions from journalists considered unfriendly.

Similarly, this reality further manifests during electoral and political seasons, such as the pending 2027 election, with media briefings being a common feature. Political parties, aspirants and candidates, as well as electoral bodies at all levels frequently convene media briefings, usually designed as media relations. Moreover, Pang, Chiong & Hassan (2014, p. 273), citing other sources, conceive media relations as "all types of initiatives - including maintaining and updating media contacts, disseminating news releases, organising press conferences, offering content and responding to media queries". An important aspect of this mix is its identification of response to media queries as a component of media relations. It suggests that media briefings should, as a matter of principle, allow journalists to probe presentations made by political organisations, support groups, candidates and the Independent National Electoral Commission, rather than wholly absorbing and uncritically publishing proceeds of media briefings with little scrutiny.

However, it appears, from observations, that while regular press briefings aimed at promoting products, events, services, or an individual usually allow for robust interaction with pressmen, political press briefings are characterised by actors planted among journalists to deflect rather important issues through praise-singing and largely irrelevant questions. Often, situations also appear engineered to weary those who may have genuine questions to ask, thereby, protecting political actors from "difficult" questions, and leaving participating journalists with only pieces of information that are favourable to the media briefing organisers.

Whereas a journalist may proceed for further investigations, seeking to unearth further details (Ismail, Ahmad & Mustaffa, 2014), reference is usually made, primarily, to data realised from the press briefing, unintendedly yielding to the whims of the curators. This reality appears prevalent during electioneering and may put news editors in uncomfortable corners in view of how to deal with the stories, because according to Ibrahim, Pawanteh, Kee, Basri, Hassan and Mahmud (2011), the press always aims for news values, ethics and professionalism. This, however, could be argued otherwise owing to the findings from several Nigerian studies that report endemic bias within the Nigerian press.

Meanwhile, the 2027 general elections in Nigeria present an opportunity to interrogate this issue; how broadcast news editors perceive and treat political media briefings in their news production. The reality of the political landscape makes it quite interesting, particularly given the International Republican Institute (2026) statement of findings and recommendations, which suggested that Nigeria is bedeviled by a weakening opposition, economic hardship, insecurity, and declining confidence in political institutions. These situations, among other things, generate an avalanche of questions that should be answered.

Moreover, in Akwa Ibom State, where the government of the day has often repeatedly accused of opaqueness with the state's finances, silence over compensation disputes (Imukudo, 2026), and the Independent National Electoral Commission (INEC) sued by the Socio-Economic Rights and Accountability Project (SERAP) (Premium Times, 2026), political media briefings may be expected to address questions tied around these. Yet, the media - reporters and editors - do not determine the content of the briefings. They are, therefore, guided or believed to be guided by journalistic ethics, which could impinge on their perception and attitudes towards political media briefings, as well the treatment they give to information from the briefings in their production and dissemination of news.

Statement of the Problem

With elections around the corner, political communication is heightened, with political actors including political parties, candidates seeking offices, electoral bodies, etc. interested in engaging with the electorates through the media. They take advantage of the several offerings of the media: from jingles on radio and television, newspaper and magazine adverts, online interactions, among others, they are afforded several means of communication through which they could reach the electorates. Among these, media briefings stand out owing to their amenability to interaction with journalists. They may also provide editors with direct access to political actors and their perspectives, thereby potentially broadening the range of information available for election reporting.

However, the increasing prominence of political media briefings during election periods raises important questions about their implications for editorial decision-making and the independence of news organisations. Understandably, political actors organise media briefings for diverse reasons including communicating particular issues, defending their interests, responding to opponents or influencing public discourse. This author's observation shows, also, that beyond arranging what they say at press briefings, there is a possibility of animating the engagement in ways that swing the tide to their favour, leaving several questions unanswered and grey areas uncovered. This poses a challenge to the media, who have the responsibility of reporting all sides of the story.

Thus, news editors occupy a critical position in the journalistic process, determining, among other things, the issues that receive attention, and how stories are framed for audiences. Consequently, the information supplied during briefings have the tendency to become part of the pool from which editorial decisions are made. Hence, a persistent issue becomes how editors interpret, select, verify and incorporate the data obtained from political media briefings into their bulletins. Editors are, therefore, left to determine whether a piece of information is publishable, and in what frame it should be published; also, whether it requires additional verification, and whether competing perspectives should be sought before broadcast amid meeting the news value of timeliness.

This issue is further exacerbated given the strange bed-fellow relationship between journalists, who seek access to political actors for the purpose of getting information, and the political sources, who want their interest continuously protected. This is because sustained access may create professional tensions, particularly where news organisations depend on political actors for information during periods when political events are unfolding rapidly, leaving editors to negotiate a delicate relationship between maintaining access and preserving the autonomy necessary to determine editorial priorities independently, which may appear in news editors' perception and treatment of such data. The study, therefore, leans on the foregoing to examine political media briefings from the perspective of news editors: understand editors' perception of them; and the extent to which data from political briefings may influence editorial decisions.

Research Questions

The study was guided by the following research questions:

In what ways do news editors perceive political media briefings during election periods?

To what extent do political media briefings influence editorial decisions regarding election coverage?

What opportunities and challenges do political media briefings present for electoral journalism?

In what ways do editors balance access to political sources with editorial independence?

Press Briefings as News Sources in Journalism

Unlike spontaneous encounters with political actors, briefings create a structured setting in which officials announce positions, explain policies, respond to criticism and answer journalists' questions. Hayek (2024) observes that government press conferences are principally designed to inform journalists and influence media coverage, even when they are simultaneously directed towards the wider public. Similarly, press conferences contribute to the salience of governmental issues in subsequent media discourse.

The news value of press briefings consequently derives partly from their ability to focus authoritative political information in a single journalistic encounter (Mañoso-Pacheco, 2020). At press briefings, political reporters and editors encounter announcements, explanations, quotations, clarifications and also have opportunities for follow-up questioning within a limited period. This makes the briefing a practical source for generating immediate stories. Yet, journalists, according to Cazzamatta (2026), still interpret, select, and verify the material.

Political actors, through press briefings, may determine the occasion, establish the opening narrative and decide which issues to foreground, while journalists retain some control through questioning, selection and subsequent framing. This interaction is evident in Sharra (2020), which reported that question time provided journalists with an opportunity to perform a watchdog function, but that political interests, inducements and unequal power relations could compromise journalistic independence.

The quality of briefing as a news source, therefore, is also affected by the behaviour of political actors. Shahbaz and Arif (2023) observe that journalists encounter evasive responses and, in some cases, are pressured to ask questions favourable to politicians. Hayek (2024) further notes that government actors have historically used press conferences as mechanisms for leading news coverage, with particularly strong effects where the subject matter is considered highly relevant.

Press briefings thus show usefulness, and perhaps, too, a trap to journalism. While they bring journalists close to politically consequential information, the risk of source dependence is also a possible outcome. A briefing can facilitate accountability when reporters ask probing questions, but can also become a vehicle through which political actors promote preferred narratives. Nonetheless, they are significant sites of news production, allowing journalists to seek information, while editors ultimately determine what deserves broadcast.

Opportunities and Challenges of Political Media Briefings to Journalism

Political media briefings offer journalists access to political actors, official information, as well as the opportunity to clarify government policies and question decision-makers on issues of public concern. Damissah, Isiaka, Adejare and Ogunlana (2025) suggest that they could engender timely information gathering, provide explanations of government decisions and enable reporters to obtain responses to allegations or controversies. Also characterised by question-and-answer sessions, political media briefings make room for the strengthening of journalism's watchdog role through the challenge of official narratives. Ndukwu et al. (2024) observe that they also demand accountability and expose inconsistencies between political promises and actual performance.

While news editors may have valuable material for political reporting, particularly during election periods when public interest in candidates, parties, policies and governance intensifies, Waisbord and Guazina (2024) suggest that political media briefings may conversely present significant challenges, particularly because they are often organised to advance political interests, promote favourable narratives and manage public perceptions. Moreover, access to political sources can further create unequal power relations (Malling, 2021), where journalists may depend on continued invitations, exclusive information or privileged access, which may discourage critical questioning and encourage self-censorship, especially how they may shape editorial decisions and electoral news coverage in Akwa Ibom State ahead of the 2027 general elections.

Theoretical Framework

The Gatekeeping Theory was adopted for the study. First postulated by Kurt Lewin in 1947 within the field of social psychology, it explains how information or items move through channels controlled by decision-makers. Lewin's original formulation was introduced into journalism by David Manning White in 1950, who applied the gatekeeping concept to the decisions of a newspaper wire editor. The major argument of the theory is that not all available information reaches an audience. Information encounters points at which decisions are made concerning selection, exclusion, modification, prioritisation and presentation.

In journalism, these decisions are at the foundation of which events become news and how they are presented to the media audience. Gatekeeping, therefore, places considerable importance on the actors who control these decisions. Bro and Kristensen (2024) describe contemporary gatekeeping as involving multiple interconnected forms and actors, reflecting the transformation of journalism from the relatively linear model associated with the traditional editor to a more complex digital environment. Yet, Scheffauer, Goyanes and Gil de Zúñiga (2024) found that audiences continued to value professional journalistic selection, demonstrating that editorial judgement remains important even in the face of increasing algorithmic selection.

Moreover, the continuing importance of the editor is particularly significant. Political media briefings are an important source of information for the newsroom, but the information supplied by political actors does not automatically become election news. The onus lies on editors to consider a briefing newsworthy, perhaps, based on its provision of timely information, direct access to political sources or capability to generate further stories. Editors may equally question its value because political briefings can represent carefully constructed attempts to promote particular interests, interpretations or political narratives.

From the foregoing, the Gatekeeping Theory makes it possible to understand the editor's intermediary role as a process of editorial judgement, a process that allows them to accept, reject, modify, verify, contextualise or use the briefings as a starting point for independent reporting. Meanwhile, present-day applications of the theory further suggest that editorial decisions are shaped by both organisational and professional environments. In light of this, Ndukwu et al. (2024) found that editorial policy influenced political reporting, while ownership interests could also affect the application of editorial policy; this reinforces the argument that gatekeeping is understood as an individual's personal decision, and also embedded in organisational and institutional structures.

The theory provides a framework for examining whether political information is reproduced largely as supplied, subjected to additional scrutiny, balanced with competing perspectives, or transformed into independent journalism, thus accommodating both the opportunities and challenges presented by political briefings to broadcast news editors.

Method

The qualitative design was considered appropriate and, therefore, adopted for the study, given its nature, which "seeks to understand and interpret the meanings and experiences of individuals in their natural settings" (Regmi, 2024, p. 37). The study involved collecting interview data from broadcast news editors' lived experiences, particularly on how they perceive and treat political media briefings in their production of news in Akwa Ibom State ahead of the coming 2027 elections.

News editors covering the political desk were purposively sampled in the following broadcast outfits in Akwa Ibom State: NTA Uyo, ADBN TV, and for radio, XL FM, and Inspiration FM. In addition to balancing the number of television and radio stations, these stations were selected because of their concentration on news content rather than other types of programmes. The editors and heads of news units that interviewed have

interfaced with several political media briefings ahead of the upcoming elections, and possessed sufficient knowledge to attend to the questions. In total, six (6) respondents participated in the study, consisting of three heads of news and three editors.

Data were collected through structured physical interviews, where the objectives of the study were explained to each of the participants following the instructional guide of Millum & Bromwich (2021). In addition, the questions were well-explained to the participants to ensure that they understood them before responding. Consequently, follow-up questions were asked, where necessary, to substantiate or clarify some of the comments made by the respondents.

To complete the data analysis, the Braun and Clarke six-phase framework was adopted, allowing a thematic analysis that according to Naeem, Ozuem, Howell & Ranfagni (2023), yields itself to identifying and reporting patterns hidden in a dataset. The analysis was, therefore, presented in themes that make clear the direction of thoughts of the participants in the study. Consequently, the interview data were transcribed, followed by the identification of keywords, selection of codes, development of theme, review of themes, and eventual expression of the codes. Based on these, the findings were determined and discussed.

Thematic Data Analyses

Theme One: Editors' Perceptions Of Political Media Briefings During Election Periods

The interviews reveal that respondents generally perceive political media briefings as important platforms for political communication, electoral enlightenment and access to political information. However, this positive perception is accompanied by an awareness that briefings are also strategic instruments through which political actors promote themselves, their candidates and their parties.

OEO described political briefings as "very, very key", particularly because they provide opportunities for electorates to understand candidates, interact with them and question their plans. He associated the briefings with creating an interface between political actors and the people they seek to represent. The respondent particularly put it this way: "Press briefings are good, providing opportunities for the electorate to make informed decisions where they know what to do, how to vote, and who they want to vote for." Similarly, DFI considered political briefings "critical to 2027 elections", explaining thus "I think political media briefings are critical to 2027 elections because they provide opportunities for political parties to inform citizens on issues; agendas that the political parties are promoting to the masses... in such a way that once candidates emerge, they manifest those ideologies that they sold out to the people." DFI said they enable political parties to enlighten citizens about their agendas and proposed programmes.

For BBI, political briefings provide an avenue through which parties can "sell and educate" voters about their candidates and programmes. OO, however, placed greater emphasis on the promotional dimension, describing briefings as occasions through which political parties and support groups "market or sell" the candidates they support. Thus, "When I'm invited to a political press briefing... I just know, okay, this political party or this support group has a candidate and they want me to launder the image or to project the image of the candidate... it's basically PR..."

Interpretation

The respondents, therefore, perceive political media briefings as legitimate and potentially valuable sources of electoral information, but they also recognise their strategic character. The briefing is simultaneously an information encounter and an opportunity for political actors to promote particular candidates, programmes and narratives.

Theme Two: Political Media Briefings Influence on Editorial Decisions

Data show that the briefing does not automatically determine the content of what is eventually broadcast by the outfits. Rather, its material is subjected to editorial selection, verification and, in some cases, further contextualisation. Hence, editors engage in editorial gatekeeping and selection.

BBI explicitly described the media as the "gatekeeper", explaining that political information should be assessed before being transmitted to the public. They particularly emphasised the need to avoid propaganda, hate speech and statements capable of "heating up the polity," adding "The NBC code has given us a direction to what should be done, what should be aired, and what shouldn't be aired... Information given out must be factual. Information given out must address issues and not personalities. It must not be propaganda. They must not contain hate speech... they must not contain inflammable statements that are capable of, you know, heating up the polity." Similarly, DFI explained that partisan claims are expected during political periods but indicated that the newsroom attempts to avoid material that could be defamatory or damaging.

Furthermore, data show that verification appears as a determinant of editorial treatment; a major mechanism through which briefing information is converted into news. Thus, BBI noted that political actors sometimes "overpromise", suggesting that their claims require scrutiny before being presented as factual information. Likewise, DFI maintained that information is checked before transmission and that journalists should hold a story where reliable confirmation cannot be obtained. OO similarly indicated that information found to be inconsistent with reality could be excluded following fact-checking. However, the respondent also added another angle, noting "...if it's not a good story per se, there has to be a reason we are indulging in the first place, and that's where the financial parts come in... where you work on it because the station has been paid for it." But, OEO emphasised comparing political claims with evidence and authoritative sources.

Interpretation

The data indicate that political briefings influence the pool of information available for editorial consideration without necessarily determining the final news product. Their influence is mediated through gatekeeping processes such as selection, verification, contextualisation and editorial judgement.

Theme Three: Opportunities and Challenges Presented by Political Media Briefings for Electoral Journalism

The third theme brings together the positive and negative consequences of political briefings identified by the respondents, with the opportunities largely centering on access and information, while the challenges involve commercialisation, propaganda, misinformation and deadline pressure. BBI described direct interaction with political actors as a "big opportunity for electoral journalism in Akwa Ibom". He explained that journalists could use the opportunity to ask questions, seek clarification and obtain information about candidates and their programmes. In a similar response, DFI emphasised the opportunity to obtain information "firsthand" and establish relationships with political actors. This respondent said journalists could exchange contacts with political actors and subsequently invite them for interviews or other programmes.

While OO highlighted another dimension of access, noting that informal conversations outside the formal briefing can enable journalists to obtain additional information and develop useful source relationships, data nonetheless, indicate commercialisation and political promotion as challenges, with respondents highlighting that access may be accompanied by commercial considerations. Thus, OO described political briefings as essentially "PR" and stated that briefings involving electronic media are "normally paid for". BBI likewise acknowledged that many political briefings are paid for, although they maintained that payment does not eliminate the newsroom's responsibility to verify information. Furthermore, the challenge of political influence was also expressed by OEO, who warned that resources received from political actors can "shape

your opinion and shape the way you think and the way you want to act on the job".

Further challenges have to do with time pressure and verification. Respondents acknowledged that deadline pressure constitutes another challenge. DFI said that information emerging from briefings may be time-sensitive but maintained that it should still be verified before transmission. BBI expressed the same principle through the maxim, "when in doubt, leave out".

Interpretation

Political media briefings produce a dual effect for electoral journalism. They make political information more accessible, facilitate interaction with sources and generate story opportunities; at the same time, they expose journalists to political promotion, commercial pressures, misinformation and the practical constraints of broadcast deadlines.

Theme Four: Negotiating Political-Source Access and Editorial Independence

In the fourth theme, the study's final research question is answered, as interviews reveal different perceptions of the extent to which relationships with political sources affect editorial independence. Firstly, source access is considered a potential influence, as OO acknowledged that political access and resources can influence reporting. The respondent's account suggests that where political communication becomes financially connected to media production, the distinction between editorial content and political promotion may become less clear. OEO similarly acknowledged that political resources "can influence" reporting, although they maintained that journalists' professional conscience should determine how they ultimately perform their responsibilities.

DFI introduced another dimension: unequal access, explaining that where one political party is accessible and another is unavailable, the difference in access can affect what the newsroom is able to publish. Hence, journalists may have to indicate that attempts were made to obtain the other side.

Moreover, editorial safeguards and professional independence further emerged as an intersecting negotiation point, with BBI presenting a stronger position on editorial independence. The respondent maintained that political access does not determine editorial decisions because stories are considered at editorial meetings and are guided by professional standards and Nigeria Broadcasting Commission (NBC) requirements. Furthermore, they indicated that the newsroom attempts to provide opportunities for different political parties, including less influential ones.

Interpretation

The interviews data suggest that editorial independence is not experienced as an absolute condition but as something that editors and journalists must actively negotiate. Access to political sources is professionally valuable, yet excessive dependence on particular sources, financial relationships or unequal access can create pressures that potentially affect editorial judgement. Professional ethics, editorial meetings, verification, balance and regulatory requirements consequently function as mechanisms for maintaining independence. The figure below summarises the content of respondents' data.



Figure 1: Broadcast Editors' Perception and Treatment of Political News Briefing

Discussion

Taken together, the interviews reveal a considerably more complex picture than a simple perception that political media briefings are either useful or problematic. The respondents largely recognise their informational and access value, particularly their ability to connect journalists directly with political actors and provide information about electoral developments. This is in tandem with findings in the study of Sparks & Wagner (2025), who reported the perceived credibility of elite and government sources in news reports, in addition to having a higher information adequacy than other sources. At the same time, they recognise that briefings are often strategic political communication, as equally underscored by Macnamara (2025), who described this strategy as linear; and in some cases commercially organised activities, a position that is not widely recognised by Minggirovna (2023) and Olariu, I., & Nichifor, B. (2015), but introduces questions about propaganda, source dependence, verification and editorial independence.

The most significant finding for the study is the tension between access and autonomy. The respondents' accounts suggest that political briefings can simultaneously strengthen journalism by improving access to sources and complicate journalism by introducing political, commercial and relational pressures. This tension is recognised by Malling (2021), who agrees that political news sources have some influence on journalists and journalism, although the author classifies interaction with political news sources into formal invisible and informal invisible, with the former serving as gatekeepers and the latter as agenda setters. Furthermore, some respondents' description of strong safeguards based on objectivity, editorial meetings, professional ethics and NBC regulations, is indicative that broadcast news editors still recognise the guardrails of journalism. However, in line with Charles (2025), others acknowledge that access, payment and source availability can affect the eventual publication of political information. Charles identifies, among other things, commercial pressures and an outfit's leaning as part of factors responsible for media bias in political coverage.

Data's consequent pointing towards a central interpretive proposition tilts towards a clear deduction: political media briefings are perceived as valuable sources of electoral information, but their journalistic value is mediated by editorial gatekeeping, verification practices, commercial considerations and the newsroom's attempt to preserve professional independence.

Conclusion

The findings of the study indicated several related points, showing that political media briefings ahead of the 2027 elections in Akwa Ibom State are considered veritable sources for information from which broadcast editors could generate interesting news stories that are expected to answer questions that would help the electorates make informed decisions. This takes root in the interactions with political actors that cut across parties, candidates, support groups, and even the electoral body. Hence, the respondents generally perceived them as useful for political communication and public enlightenment, but not as neutral information channels. Political media briefings' value to journalism largely depends on post-briefing activities, including the selection, verification and contextualisation of information that become news.

Moreover, the findings revealed a tension between access to political actors and editorial independence, feared to attract political and financial relationships, unequal access to competing political actors, partisan claims, misinformation and broadcast deadlines create pressures that can complicate editorial judgement. However, journalistic significance of political media briefings lies in the editorial processes through which that information is negotiated before it reaches the electorate.

Recommendation

Consequently, the recommendation in this study follows that news organisations should strengthen newsroom protocols for handling political briefings, particularly through systematic verification, clear separation of paid political communication from editorial content, balanced sourcing and documentation of attempts to obtain competing perspectives.

AI Disclosure

A number of artificial intelligence tools were employed to aid some aspects of the study. For instance, audioconvert.ai and elevenlabs.io were used to process the transcription of the recorded interviews. Likewise, ChatGPT and Gemini were used to extract the quotes that buttress the developed themes for the study, and ChatGPT alone was used to generate the infographic labelled as Figure 1.

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